Matthew Lavallee

mplavallee.com

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Education

2023 - 2027 **Johns Hopkins University** - Baltimore, Maryland *(Expected)*
Ph.D., Health Economics & Policy
Committee: Mark Meiselbach, Katherine Miller, and Daniel Polsky
Dissertation: *Public Reinsurance and Market Design in the ACA Individual Market*

2016 - 2020 **Hampshire College** - Amherst, Massachusetts
B.A., Economics & Mathematics
Committee: Lynda Pickbourn and Ethan Meyers
Senior Thesis: *The Effect of Guaranteed Cash Transfers on Deaths of Despair*

Research Interests

My primary research agenda focuses on the influence of plan design in public programs and the downstream impacts on enrollees.

Broadly, my interests include: health and social policy, health economics, and public health insurance.

Dissertation and Job Market Paper

Title: Public Reinsurance and Market Design in the ACA Individual Market

Description: Since 2018, 18 states have used Section 1332 waivers to fund reinsurance programs that reimburse insurers for high-cost enrollees' claims. In my dissertation, I investigate how reinsurance reshapes insurers' pricing, plan design and provider networks, and enrollees' care, using national plan and network data and Colorado's All-Payer Claims Database. I find that reinsurance lowers premiums by about 17 percent, with the most expensive plans having the highest reductions. Insurers also redesign plans in ways consistent with a weaker incentive to avoid complex-care enrollees: silver plans shift specialist visits from coinsurance toward flat copays, and plans become 18 percentage points more likely to cover a children's hospital in their region and 13 points more likely to cover its flagship teaching hospital. In Colorado, plans in regions with larger subsidies began covering and more frequently retaining sicker enrollees. Reinsurance can thus make plans more generous for complex-care enrollees.

Job Market Paper: The Effect of Reinsurance on Network Design

Professional Experience

2025 - Research Assistant, National Bureau of Economic Research

2022 - 2023 Research Associate, Boston College

2020 - 2022 Tobin Pre-Doctoral Fellow, Yale University

2019 - 2020 Data Scientist, National Science Foundation's Data Science Corps

Fellowships and Grants

2023 - 2025 Predoctoral National Research Service Award Fellowship (T32), AHRQ

Peer-Reviewed Work

1. Mark K. Meiselbach, **Matthew Lavallee**, Matthew Zahn, Jianhui Xu, Daniel Polsky. 2026. "Forced Disenrollments Among Medicare Advantage Beneficiaries Following 2026 Plan Exits" *JAMA* [The Washington Post, Reuters]
2. **Matthew Lavallee**, Andrew Anderson, Laura J. Samuel, Kali S. Thomas, Mark K. Meiselbach. 2026. "Physician Network Breadth in Medicare Advantage Plans Offering Part B Premium Givebacks" *JAMA Network Open*
3. Hannah Factor, Jacob Wallace, **Matthew Lavallee**, Anthony Lollo Jr, Chima Ndumele. 2025. "SNAP Work Requirements Reversal and Program Enrollment" *JAMA Health Forum*
4. Jacob Wallace, Chima Ndumele, Anthony Lollo Jr, Danil Agafiev Macambira, **Matthew Lavallee**, Beniamino Green, Kate A. Duchowny, J. Michael McWilliams. 2024. "Attributing Racial Differences in Care to Plan Performance or Selection" *JAMA Internal Medicine*
5. Chima Ndumele, Hannah Factor, **Matthew Lavallee**, Anthony Lollo, Jacob Wallace. 2024. "Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Work Requirements and Safety-Net Program Participation" *JAMA Internal Medicine*
6. **Matthew Lavallee**, Sandro Galea, Nadia N. Abuelezam. 2023. "Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Emergency Allotments and Food Security, Hospitalizations, and Hospital Capacity" *JAMA Network Open*
7. Jacob Wallace, Anthony Lollo Jr, Kate A Duchowny, **Matthew Lavallee**, Chima D Ndumele. 2022. "Disparities in Health Care Spending and Utilization Among Black and White Medicaid Enrollees" *JAMA Health Forum*

Other Articles

1. Mark Meiselbach, **Matthew Lavallee**. 2026. "H.R.1 Threatens The Stability Of Medicaid Managed Care" *Health Affairs Forefront*

Work in Progress

1. **Matthew Lavallee**, Mark Meiselbach, David Anderson, Sih-Ting Cai, Kelly Anderson. "The Effect of Network Adequacy Regulations: Evidence from Medicare Advantage"
2. **Matthew Lavallee**, Chima Ndumele, Mark Meiselbach. "SNAP Benefit Cuts and Labor Supply: National Evidence from the End of Emergency Allotments"
3. Mark Meiselbach, **Matthew Lavallee**, Jean Abraham, Caitlin Carroll. "The Effect of Dropped Coverage on Coverage, Utilization, and Spending: Evidence from Colorado"
4. Lauren Booth, **Matthew Lavallee**, Anna Sick-Samuels, Megan Tschudy, and Katherine Miller. "Exploring Well-Child Visits in the U.S. Before and After COVID-19: A Cross-sectional Descriptive Study of the National Survey of Children's Health"
5. Sarah Henderson, Yutong Zhang, **Matthew Lavallee**, Katherine Miller. "The Medicaid Unwinding Among Older Adults and Adults with Disabilities"

Academic Conference Presentations

2026	ASHEcon: Does Generosity Matter? Evidence from the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program
2025	APPAM: The Effect of Network Adequacy Standards on Specialty Networks
	AcademyHealth: The Effect of Specialty Networks on Cardiovascular Care
	AcademyHealth: Evaluating the Effects of Medicare Advantage Network Adequacy Regulations

Teaching Experience

Guest Lectures

2026	Managed Care in Public Insurance (Fundamentals of Health Policy & Management)
2025	Politics, Policy, & Health (Fundamentals of Health Policy & Management)

Teaching Assistant

Johns Hopkins University

2026 - 2027	Intermediate Health Economics‡, Mark Meiselbach
2026	Fundamentals of Health Policy & Management, Nicholas Meyerson
2026	Managed Care and Health Insurance‡, Gretchen Jacobson & Jonathan Weiner
2025	Strategic Leadership and Decision Making‡, Conan Dickson
2025	Advanced Methods in Health Services Research: Analysis‡, Katherine Miller
2025	Fundamentals of Health Policy & Management, Conan Dickson & John Colmers
2024 - 2026	Applied Microeconomics‡, Matthew Eisenberg

Hampshire College

2020	Introduction to Statistics and Experimental Design, Elizabeth Conlisk
2018	Introduction to Statistics, Ethan Meyers

‡Graduate level.

Professional Service

2024 -	Peer reviewer: Health Services Research, American Journal of Public Health
2025	Student Representative, HPM Self Study Committee
2024 - 2026	Student Representative, Academic Policy and Admissions Committee
2024 - 2025	Doctoral Academic Co-Chair, Student Coordinating Committee